

English

Year 1

Cambridge Early Years

Student Manual



My First English Book



English · Year 1 · Student Book. First edition, 2026.

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Every story, rhyme, character, fact file and illustration in this book was written and drawn for Prime School. Any resemblance to real people, or to other published works, is coincidental. The two traditional tales retold here, **The Little Round Bun** and **Anansi and Tortoise**, are new retellings in our own words of folk stories that belong to everybody.

For teachers

This book is meant to be written in. Pupils will trace, circle, tick and draw on these pages, and that is the point.

There are **no printed answers** anywhere in this book. Let students say what they think out loud first, then choose, circle or write. Read every instruction aloud together before pupils begin.

Every new word is printed **with its own picture**, so a child who cannot yet read the word can still read the page.

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What is inside?



Nine stops on one trail. You will walk the whole way this year.

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WELCOME

This book is a trail

A trail is a path you walk. This one goes all the way through the year, and there are **nine stops** along it. At every stop something happens: a bus comes, a rocket goes up, a bun runs away, a penguin looks for his friends.

You do not have to read on your own yet. That is what the pictures are for. Every new word in this book comes with its own picture, so you can always read the page.

★ Did you know?

Your brain learns a new word best when you **say it out loud**. So say every new word in this book at least three times: once to yourself, once to a friend, and once as loudly as you dare.

Before you set off

Point at the picture above. Who can you see? What are they reaching for? Where do you think the letters are going?

Meet your friends



Leo, Mia, Sofia, Pip and Hoot. You will meet them on every stop.

 **Leo**

Leo asks **why** about everything. He wears a yellow hoodie with a blue star.

 **Mia**

Mia claps the beat of every rhyme. She has two bunches and a pink bow.

 **Sofia**

Sofia likes to sort things into groups. She notices what other people miss.

 **Pip**

Pip is the smallest and the bravest. He also loses things.

 **Hoot, Fen and Bo**

Hoot is an owl with round glasses. When something is worth knowing, Hoot tells you. **Fen** the fox and **Bo** the rabbit walk the trail with you: look for them on the cover.

Signs to look for

The same friendly signs come back on every page. Once you know them, you will always know what to do next.



Let us talk

A question to talk about before you start.



A quick game to wake your voice up.



Read with me

A story or some facts, read together out loud.



Go a bit further

An extra idea, if you would like more.



Did you know?

A true and surprising fact.



Big challenge

A harder task. Take your time.

1

Your turn means it is your turn to do something. A dashed box is always yours to write or draw in.

Nothing in this book has the answer printed in it. You say what you think first, then choose.

Turn back to this page whenever you forget what a sign means.

Before you start



Your reading kit. You will not need all of it at once.

✓ Four good reading habits

1. **Point as you read.** Your finger keeps your eyes in the right place.
2. **Say it out loud.** Ears learn faster than eyes do.
3. **Look at the picture first.** It tells you what the words are about.
4. **Stop and ask.** A word you do not know is a good question, not a mistake.

Here is the whole alphabet



The five yellow letters are the **vowels**. Almost every word you will ever read has at least one of them in it, so we start there.

For teachers

The strip above is deliberately lower case: children meet lower case far more often in real reading, so it is taught first and capitals arrive as a job.

PART ONE

First Steps

Five vowels, your first sounds, and ten words you will know by heart.



- 1 The five vowels, one at a time
- 2 How to make each letter with a pencil
- 3 Ten words you will know by heart
- 4 Your very first story

Meet the letter a



Open your mouth wide and let the sound fall out: **a**, like the first sound in **apple**. Say it three times, then say it as quietly as you can.



Leo points at the apples. Look for three things that start with **a**.

- 1 Point at each picture below. Say the word out loud. Can you hear **a** at the start?



apple



ant



alligator

- 2 Now find the letter **a** in the row underneath. Circle every one you find. There are four.



Write the letter a



Aa

look

Aa

now trace

- 1 Put your pencil on the dot and follow the dashes. Do the big letters first, then the small ones.
- 2 Now write it on your own. Start at the top, and keep the letter sitting on the bottom line.

a a a

- 3 Copy each word once. Say the word before you write it.



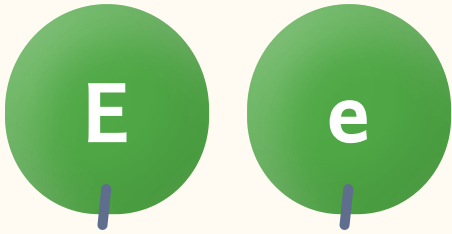
apple



ant

Start every letter at the top. Say the movement out loud as your pencil goes: that is how your hand remembers it.

Meet the letter e



Smile a little and say **e**, like the first sound in **egg**. Say it three times, then say it as quietly as you can.

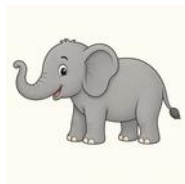


Mia listens carefully. Look for three things that start with **e**.

- 1 Point at each picture below. Say the word out loud. Can you hear **e** at the start?



egg



elephant



engine

- 2 Now find the letter **e** in the row underneath. Circle every one you find. There are four.



Write the letter e



Ee

look

Ee

now trace

- 1 Put your pencil on the dot and follow the dashes. Do the big letters first, then the small ones.
- 2 Now write it on your own. Start at the top, and keep the letter sitting on the bottom line.

e e e

- 3 Copy each word once. Say the word before you write it.



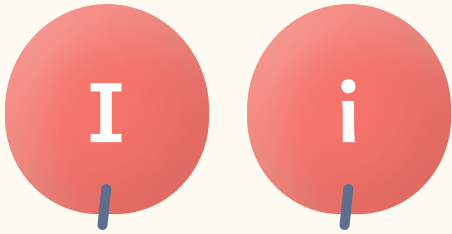
egg



elephant

Start every letter at the top. Say the movement out loud as your pencil goes: that is how your hand remembers it.

Meet the letter i



Make your mouth small and short: **i**, like the first sound in **ink**. Say it three times, then say it as quietly as you can.



Sofia looks closely. Look for three things that start with **i**.

- 1 Point at each picture below. Say the word out loud. Can you hear **i** at the start?



ink



igloo



iguana

- 2 Now find the letter **i** in the row underneath. Circle every one you find. There are four.



Write the letter i



Ii

look

Ii

now trace

- 1 Put your pencil on the dot and follow the dashes. Do the big letters first, then the small ones.
- 2 Now write it on your own. Start at the top, and keep the letter sitting on the bottom line.

iii

- 3 Copy each word once. Say the word before you write it.



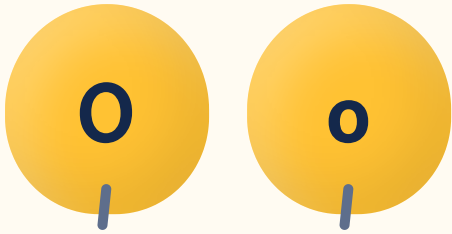
ink



igloo

Start every letter at the top. Say the movement out loud as your pencil goes: that is how your hand remembers it.

Meet the letter o



Make your mouth a round hole: **o**, like the first sound in **octopus**. Say it three times, then say it as quietly as you can.



Pip reaches out. Look for three things that start with **o**.

- 1 Point at each picture below. Say the word out loud. Can you hear **o** at the start?



octopus



orange



owl

- 2 Now find the letter **o** in the row underneath. Circle every one you find. There are four.



Write the letter o



O o

look



now trace

1 Put your pencil on the dot and follow the dashes. Do the big letters first, then the small ones.

2 Now write it on your own. Start at the top, and keep the letter sitting on the bottom line.

o o o

3 Copy each word once. Say the word before you write it.



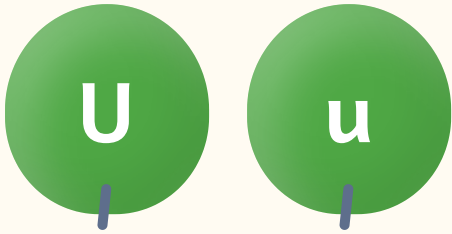
octopus



orange

Start every letter at the top. Say the movement out loud as your pencil goes: that is how your hand remembers it.

Meet the letter u



Push the sound out from your tummy: **u**, like the first sound in **umbrella**. Say it three times, then say it as quietly as you can.



It is raining. Look for three things that start with **u**.

- 1 Point at each picture below. Say the word out loud. Can you hear **u** at the start?



umbrella



up



unicorn

- 2 Now find the letter **u** in the row underneath. Circle every one you find. There are four.



Write the letter u



U u

look

U u

now trace

- 1 Put your pencil on the dot and follow the dashes. Do the big letters first, then the small ones.
- 2 Now write it on your own. Start at the top, and keep the letter sitting on the bottom line.

u u u

- 3 Copy each word once. Say the word before you write it.



umbrella



up

Start every letter at the top. Say the movement out loud as your pencil goes: that is how your hand remembers it.

All five vowels



Here they all are together. Say them along the row, then backwards. Then say them as fast as you can.

1 Match each vowel to a picture that starts with it. Draw a line.

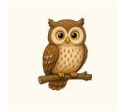
a

e

i

o

u



owl



egg



umbrella



ant



igloo

2 Say the five vowels along the row again, then backwards, then as fast as you can.

Which vowel is missing?



- 1 Say the word for each picture. One letter has floated away. Write the vowel that is missing.



_ nt



_ gg



_ wl

- 2 Colour every balloon that has a vowel on it. Leave the others white.



★ Did you know?

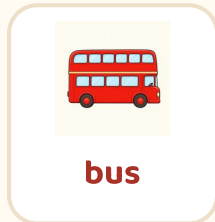
There are only **five** vowels but **twenty-one** other letters. Those five little letters do an enormous amount of work: try saying a sentence without using any of them.

Say your own name slowly. Which vowels can you hear inside it?

Four more sounds



These four sounds start hundreds of words. Say each one, then say a word that starts with it.



1 Say each word out loud. Sort them into the right tray.

b words

.....

.....

m words

.....

.....

s and t



s

t



sign



sock



sit



train



town



tree

- 1 Point at each picture and say the word. Then write the first letter on the line.



sock



tree

→ Go a bit further

Go round your classroom and find one thing that starts with **b**, one with **m**, one with **s** and one with **t**. Say each one to a friend.

Four words to keep

Some words you do not sound out. You just **know** them, the way you know your own front door. Here are the first four.

I

always a big letter

a

one little letter

am

I am Leo.

is

This is Mia.

- 1 Read each word out loud three times. Then copy it on the line underneath it.

I am Leo.

This **is** Mia.

Mia has **a** red bow.

- 2 Read the three sentences above with your teacher. Point at each word as you say it. Then find the word **is** and put your finger on it.

★ WORDS ON THIS PAGE



see



like



book

FIRST STEPS

15

Three more words

my

my bag

the

the bus

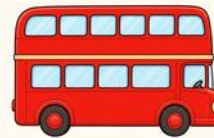
can

I can hop.

1 Read, then copy. Say the word out loud before you write it.



my bag



the bus

2 Read each sentence with your teacher. Circle **yes** if it is true for you.

I can hop.

YES / NO

I can see the bus.

YES / NO

My bag is red.

YES / NO

Say a sentence out loud starting with I can. Then one starting with My.

The last three

see

I see a fox.

like

I like buns.

you

Can you see?

- 1 Read the ten words below. These are your ten by-heart words.
Tick each one you can read on your own.

I

a

am

is

my

the

can

see

like

you

★ Big challenge

Ten words is enough to build hundreds of sentences. Say five different sentences using only words from that row. Count them on your fingers.

★ WORDS ON THIS PAGE



bag



bus



fox

The word hunt



Leo and Sofia hunt for words they know.

- 1 Hunt through the box below. Every time you find one of your ten by-heart words, circle it. There are twelve to find.

the bat I mug can sit
my see top is a ten
you am bus like the I

- 2 Now count. How many did you find? Write the number in the box.

how many?

Play the hunt again tomorrow. Can you beat your own score?

Build a sentence



Mia and Pip push the words into a line.

A sentence needs three things: a big letter at the start, words that make sense together, and a full stop at the end.

- 1 Read the four words. Then say them in an order that makes sense.

see

I

bus

the

- 2 Now write your sentence on the line. Do not forget the big letter and the full stop.

your sentence

- 3 Now try the same with **bag**, **is**, **My** and **red**, out loud.

Fen and Bo



I am Fen. I am a fox.

I can see a book.

The book is big!

I like the book.

Can you see it too?

Your first story, by Prime Books

1 Read the story with your teacher. Point at each word as you say it.

2 Read it again on your own. Every single word is one of your ten by-heart words, or a word you have practised.

You just read a whole story. Say that out loud.

Five sentences. Five big letters. Five full stops. Count them.

Talk about Fen

1 Read each sentence. Circle **true** or **not true**.

Fen is a fox.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

Fen can see a book.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

The book is small.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

Fen likes the book.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

2 Which picture shows Fen? Circle it.



fox



owl



duck

3 Copy the two words from the story. Say each one first.



fox



book

Look how far you came



The end of Part One. The trail starts properly on the next page.

How did it go?

I can say all five vowels.	☐	☐	☐
I can write the five vowels.	☐	☐	☐
I can hear the first sound in a word.	☐	☐	☐
I can read my ten by-heart words.	☐	☐	☐
I can read a whole short story.	☐	☐	☐

Green means yes. Yellow means nearly. Red means not yet, and not yet is a perfectly good answer.

★ Did you know?

You have learned five vowels, four consonants and ten whole words. That is nineteen new things, and you did it in a few weeks.

1

STOP 1

Going places

A red bus, a long road, and somebody waiting
at the other end. Get on board.



1 The words for getting about

2 A rhyme you can clap

3 The Bus to Berry Hill

4 Signs in the street

How do you get about?

 Before we set off

How do you come to school? Do you walk, or ride, or come in a car? Who comes with you? Tell your partner, then listen to theirs.

 On this stop you will

- ✓ name six ways to travel
- ✓ clap the beat of a rhyme
- ✓ read a whole story with your teacher
- ✓ hear the first sound in a word

Ways to travel

Point at each picture. Say the word out loud.



bus



bike



car



van



train



boat

**warm
up**

Say the six words again, but this time in a whisper. Then say them like a giant.

Which one is bigger?



Six ways to travel, all lined up together.

- 1 Talk with your partner. Which is **bigger**, the car or the van?
Which has **two** wheels? Which one goes on **water**?
- 2 Count the wheels. Write the number in the box beside each picture.



bike



car

★ Did you know?

The double-decker bus was invented so that more people could fit on the same short piece of road. Going **up** was cheaper than making the streets wider.

Draw one more way of travelling that is not on this page.

MEET THE LETTER

The sound b and m



Press your lips together, then let the sound pop out: **b**. For **m**, keep your lips closed and hum. Feel your nose buzz.

b m

look

b m

now trace

♪ b



bus



bell



bike

♪ m



map



mug



mat

Now make b and m yourself



- 1 Say every word out loud. Which have the sound at the **start**, and which at the **end**? Then copy the two words below.

bus

map

bell

mug

bike

mat



bus



map

- 2 Say **bus** slowly. Which sound comes first? Now say **map**. Which sound comes first there?

A rhyme to ride along to

Ride With Me

Ride with me, ride with me,
Up the **hill** and down.
Ride with me, ride with me,
All the way to **town**.
Beep, beep! Here we go,
Fast, and then **slow, slow, slow**.

● ● ● ● Clap once for every beat. Six claps a line.

A Prime Books rhyme

- 1 Say the rhyme with your teacher. Then say it again and clap the beat. Go fast on **fast** and slow right down on **slow**.
- 2 Two words in the rhyme sound the same at the end. Say **down** and **town**. Can you hear it? Those two **rhyme**.

The -own family



down



town



crown

Before you read



The first picture of the story. Look at it for a long moment.



Look and guess

The story is called **The Bus to Berry Hill**. Who is waiting at the bus stop? Where do you think the bus is going? Who might be waiting at the other end?

1

Tell your partner what you think happens in this story. You do not have to be right. Guessing is part of reading.

★ Did you know?

Good readers guess all the time. Your brain is already working out what comes next, using the picture, the title and everything you have ever seen before.

The Bus to Berry Hill



A big red bus waits at the stop.

It is the bus to **Berry Hill**.

We get on the bus.

Off we go!

1 Read the four sentences with your teacher. Point at each word.

Berry Hill is the name of a place, so it starts with a big letter. Names always do.



bus



stop



hill

Past the pond



We sit at the back.

The bus goes fast.

We hold on tight.

We go past the **pond**.

We go past the **clock**.

- 1 Read it again on your own. Then find the word **fast** and put your finger on it.



pond



clock



sit

→ Go a bit further

Say the story in your own words, as if you were on the bus. What can you see out of the window?

Grandpa is waiting



At last we get to **Berry Hill**.

I press the **bell**. Ding!

Grandpa is waiting at the stop.

I run and give him a big hug.

Grandpa and Berry Hill are both names. Both get a big letter, wherever they sit in the sentence.



grandpa



bell



run

The end. Tell your partner your favourite part.

True or not true?



- 1 Your teacher reads each sentence. Say **true** or **not true** out loud together. Then circle your answer.

The bus goes to Berry Hill.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

The bus goes past the pond.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

The bus is very slow.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

Grandpa waits at the stop.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

- 2 Say each word below. Sort them by their **first sound**.

bus

map

bell

mug

bike

mat

b words

.....

.....

.....

m words

.....

.....

.....

★ WORDS ON THIS PAGE



32

Tell the story again

- 1 Use this map to tell **The Bus to Berry Hill** in your own words. Take turns with your partner.



stop



pond



clock



Berry Hill

- 2 Now put these four sentences in order. Write **1, 2, 3, 4** in the boxes.

☐

We go past the pond and the clock.

☐

Grandpa is waiting at the stop.

☐

We get on the bus.

☐

We sit at the back of the bus.

A sentence begins with a big letter and ends with a full stop.

Shops and signs



Berry Hill high street. Every shop has an empty sign.

- 1 Look at the street. What can you see? Talk about the signs you see on a shop door and in a shop window.
- 2 Write a name on each blank sign. Start like this: **This is the bakery.**

bakery

book shop

your shop



shop



sign



town

→ Go a bit further

Play shops with a partner. One of you is the shopkeeper and one is the shopper. Say hello, then ask for something.

The words from Stop 1



Every word you met on this stop, with its own picture. Read them to somebody at home.



bus



bike



car



van



train



boat



stop



hill



bell



pond



clock



town



shop



sign



grandpa



run

Sixteen new words. Point at one and say it. Now point at another.

Make your own bus stop sign



- 1 Choose a name for your own stop. Berry Hill is taken.
- 2 Draw the sign on a piece of card. Make the letters big.
- 3 Write the name on it. Use a big letter to start.
- 4 Hold it up and tell your class where your bus goes.

Practise once before you show your class. Once is enough to make the second time feel easy.

Think about this stop

Colour one circle for each line. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, red means not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer.

I can name six ways to travel.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can read the story with my teacher.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can hear b and m at the start of a word.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can use a big letter for a name.	☐ ☐ ☐

Now I can

- ☐ I can talk about how I travel.
- ☐ I can say whether a sentence is true.
- ☐ I can hear the first sound in a word.
- ☐ I can read The Bus to Berry Hill.

★ SAY THESE BEFORE YOU GO



bus



hill



grandpa

Next stop: 2 · Having fun

2

STOP 2

Having fun

Two friends, one sunny afternoon, and a competition nobody quite wins.

1 Words for what your body does

2 Kit and Pat, a story in speech

3 Doing words and naming words

4 Rhymes that end the same

What do you do to keep fit?

 Before we start

What is your favourite thing to do outside? Do you do it on your own or with friends? Is there a sport you would like to be able to do?

 On this stop you will

- ✓ say what your body can do
- ✓ read a story where people speak
- ✓ tell a doing word from a naming word
- ✓ find words that end the same way

Doing words



run



hop



jog



sit



ball



rope

**warm
up**

Stand up. When your teacher says a word from the row above, do it.

The sound sh



Two letters, but only **one** sound. Put your finger on your lips and say **sh**, like asking somebody to be quiet.

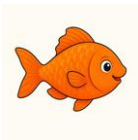
sh

look

sh

now trace

♪ sh



fish



dish



brush

Now make sh yourself

- 1 Say every word out loud. Which have the sound at the **start**, and which at the **end**? Then copy the two words below.

sh is the first digraph in this book: two letters making one sound. Name it explicitly, because children who expect one letter to equal one sound get stuck here otherwise.

Note that sh appears at the END of all three words above. Ending sounds are easier to hear than middle ones, so they come first.



fish



dish

- 2 Say **fish**. Now say it again without the **sh**. What is left? Try the same with **dish**.

Kit and Pat



Kit and Pat like the sun.

Kit and Pat like to run.

“I can run fast,” said Kit.

“Can you run fast, Pat?”

Somebody is speaking

When you see marks like “ ” round some words, somebody is **saying** them out loud. Read those bits the way that person would say them.

- 1 Read the story again. Use a proud voice for Kit.

Show me, show me



“I can hop on a box,” said Pat.

“I can hop with a mug!”

“Show me, show me,” said Kit.

“What more can you do?”



box



mug



hop

→ Go a bit further

Say a sentence that starts **I can** and finish it with something silly.
Then it is your partner's turn.

Down with a thud



“I can jog in the mud,” said Pat.

“I can jog with a frog!”

Oops! Down with a thud.

“Are you sad?” said Kit.

“No,” said Pat. “I am wet, and I like it.”

- 1 Read the end of the story. Who fell over? Was Pat cross about it?

A story can be funny and kind at the same time.

Doing words and naming words

 Two jobs a word can do

Doing words tell you what somebody does: run, hop, jog, sit.

Naming words tell you what something is: box, mug, frog, mud.

1 Say each word. Put it in the right tray.

run

box

hop

frog

sit

mug

Doing words

.....

.....

.....

Naming words

.....

.....

.....

2 Choose one doing word. Say a sentence about Pat using it.

 **For teachers**

The words verb and noun can wait. What matters at Year 1 is the sorting behaviour: does this word tell me an action, or does it name a thing?

Pupils who sort confidently are ready for the labels; introduce them then, not before.

Rhyme families

🎵 -ug



mug



jug



rug

🎵 -og



frog



jog



dog

1 Say each family out loud, one after the other. The ending never changes. Only the first sound does.

2 Which word does **not** belong in the -ug family? Circle it.

mug

jug

fish

rug

★ Did you know?

Once you know one rhyme family you can read the whole family.
Learn **-ug** and you have four words for the price of one.

Words in our class



Six empty name cards, waiting.

- 1 Write the names of six people in your class. Every name gets a **big letter** at the start.

six names

Here is the alphabet again



- 2 Find the letter your own name starts with. Is it near the start, the middle or the end of the alphabet?

→ Go a bit further

Put your six names in alphabet order. Start with the one whose letter comes first.

The words from Stop 2

All the words from this stop, each with its picture.



run



hop



jog



sit



box



mug



jug



rug



frog



fish



dish



brush



ball



rope



cap



six

Say four of these words in one sentence. Any four.

Act out Kit and Pat



- 1 Choose who is Kit and who is Pat.
- 2 Read your lines out loud twice, until they feel easy.
- 3 Add the actions: run, hop, jog, and the thud at the end.
- 4 Perform it for your class. Use your biggest voice.

Practise once before you show your class. Once is enough to make the second time feel easy.

Think about this stop

Colour one circle for each line. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, red means not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer.

I can read a story where people speak.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can sort doing words from naming words.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can hear sh at the end of a word.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can write six names with big letters.	☐ ☐ ☐

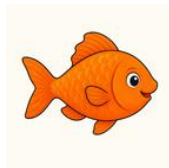
Now I can

- ☐ I can say what my body can do.
- ☐ I can read words that people say out loud.
- ☐ I can find words that rhyme.
- ☐ I can hear the sound sh.

★ SAY THESE BEFORE YOU GO



run



fish



mug

Next stop: 3 · Let us find out

3

STOP 3

Let us find out

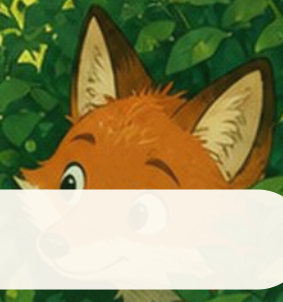
Some books tell you a story. Other books tell you what is true. This stop is about the second kind.

1 Story books and fact books

2 A fact file about foxes

3 What baby animals are called

4 The sounds ng and ck



Two kinds of book



Before we start

Think of a book you love. Does it tell you a story that somebody made up, or does it tell you things that are really true? How can you tell which kind it is?



On this stop you will

- ✓ tell a story book from a fact book
- ✓ use a contents page to find something
- ✓ read a fact file and answer questions
- ✓ name the babies of five animals



How to tell them apart

A **story book** has characters who do things. Somebody made them up. A **fact book** has real photographs and real facts, and it has a **contents page** so you can jump straight to what you want.

1

Look at the books in your class library. Find one story book and one fact book. Show your partner how you knew.

How a fact book helps you

A contents page

1	All about foxes	2
2	Where a fox lives	4
3	What a fox eats	7
4	Fox cubs	9
5	Foxes in town	12

1 Read the contents page above with your teacher. On which page would you look to find out about baby foxes? Point at it.

2 Answer out loud. Which page tells you what a fox eats? What would you find on page 12?

★ Did you know?

A contents page saves you reading a whole book to find one fact.

Fact file: the fox



A fox with her cubs at the mouth of the den.

A fox lives in a hole called a **den**.

A baby fox is called a **cub**.

A fox eats almost anything: berries, worms, beetles, mice and birds.

A fox comes out mostly at night.



fox



den



cub

A fact is something that is true whether you like it or not.

What did you find out?



- 1 Read the fact file again. Then circle **true** or **not true**.

A fox lives in a den.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

A baby fox is called a cub.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

A fox only eats grass.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

A fox comes out mostly at night.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

- 2 Where could you find out more about foxes? Talk about all three.



In a book

Use the contents page.



By asking

Ask somebody who knows.

- 3 Write **one** fact about a fox on the line. Big letter to start, full stop at the end.

★ WORDS ON THIS PAGE



fox



den



cub

STOP 3

53

Foxes in town



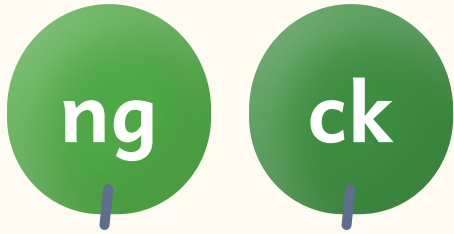
Some foxes live in towns.
A town fox looks in bins for food.
It runs along the pavement at night.
In the day it sleeps.

- 1 Have you ever seen a wild animal near your home? Tell your partner what it was and what it was doing.

★ Did you know?

A fox in a town has a shorter walk to dinner than a fox in the countryside, so town foxes often live in a smaller patch of land.

The sound ng and ck



Both are two letters with **one** sound, and both come at the **end** of a word. For **ng** let the sound hum in your nose. For **ck** stop it sharply with the back of your tongue.

ngck

look

ngck

now trace

ng

ck



ring



king



sing



sock



rock



duck

Now make ng and ck yourself



- 1 Say every word out loud. Which have the sound at the **start**, and which at the **end**? Then copy the two words below.

ng and ck never begin an English word, so they are taught here purely as endings. Pupils who try to start a word with them are applying a sensible rule to an exception: say so, rather than marking it wrong.

Both are hard to hear in isolation. Say the whole word, then just the ending, then the whole word again.



ring



sock

- 2 Say **sing** and **sock**. One hums and one stops. Which is which?

Baby animals



Every baby animal has its own special name.

1 Read each pair with your teacher. Say the baby word twice.



lamb

a baby sheep



calf

a baby cow



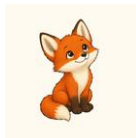
duckling

a baby duck



kitten

a baby cat



cub

a baby fox



chick

a baby penguin

★ Big challenge

A baby goat is called a **kid**. A baby horse is called a **foal**. Say all eight baby words without looking.

Label the cat



One cat, six parts to find.

1 Read the six words. Then point at that part on the cat.



fur



tail



eyes

2 Now draw a line from each word to the right part of the cat.
Say the word as you draw.

ears

eyes

teeth

fur

legs

tail

→ Go a bit further

A cat is in the same family as a lion, a tiger and a leopard. Say what all four have in common.

Five little ducklings

Five Little Ducklings

Five little ducklings went out one **day**,
Over the hill and far **away**.
Mother Duck called, “Quack, quack, quack!”
But only four little ducklings came **back**.

● ● ● ● Hold up five fingers. Put one down each time you say it.

A Prime Books counting rhyme



- 1 Say the rhyme four times over, taking one duckling away each time. How many are left at the end?
- 2 Two words in the rhyme rhyme with each other. Say **day** and **away**. Now find the third rhyming word.

Rhymes are easy to remember on purpose. That is why so many counting games are rhymes.

The words from Stop 3

Fact words and animal words, each with its picture.



fox



den



cub



lamb



calf



duckling



kitten



duck



ring



king



sing



sock



rock



leaf



tree



fur

Choose one animal word. Say a true fact about that animal.

Make a fact file



- 1 Choose an animal you already know something about.
- 2 Draw it in the middle of a big sheet of paper.
- 3 Write three true facts around your drawing.
- 4 Read your fact file to your class. Say where you found out.

Practise once before you show your class. Once is enough to make the second time feel easy.

Think about this stop

Colour one circle for each line. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, red means not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer.

I can tell a story book from a fact book.	☐	☐	☐
I can use a contents page.	☐	☐	☐
I can name five baby animals.	☐	☐	☐
I can hear ng and ck at the end of a word.	☐	☐	☐

Now I can

- ☐ I can find a fact in a book.
- ☐ I can answer a question about what I read.
- ☐ I can name the babies of five animals.
- ☐ I can hear the sounds ng and ck.

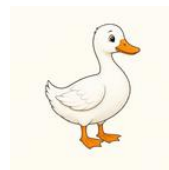
★ SAY THESE BEFORE YOU GO



fox



cub



duck

Next stop: 4 · Up in space

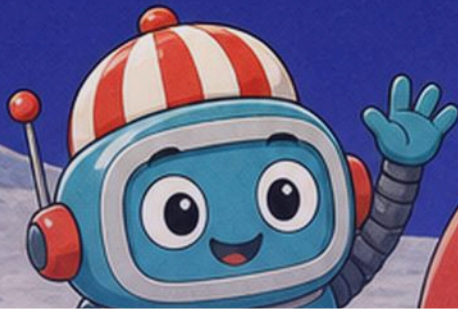
4

STOP 4

Up in space



A small robot, a small rocket, and a very big moon. What could possibly go wrong?



1 Nim on the Moon, a story in order

2 What every sentence starts with

3 The -ast family

4 Write a postcard from the moon

What is on the moon?

 Before we start

Look up at the moon tonight. Is it round, or is it a thin curve?
What do you think you would find if you went there? Would you take anything with you?

 On this stop you will

- ✓ read a story that happens in order
- ✓ say what a sentence starts with
- ✓ count the sentences on a page
- ✓ find words in the -ast family

Space words



moon



star



rocket



robot

**warm
up**

Count down from ten to one with your whole class, then shout **blast off!** together.

The sound a and s and t



Three sounds you already know, and now they join up. Say them one after another and let them run together: **a ... s ... t.**

ast

look

ast

now trace

🎵 -ast



fast



last



mast

Now make a and s and t yourself

- 1 Say every word out loud. Which have the sound at the **start**, and which at the **end**? Then copy the two words below.

This page teaches a rime, not a single letter: -ast. Blending three known sounds into a chunk is the step that turns letter knowledge into reading.

Say the whole rime, then add one onset at a time: f-ast, l-ast, m-ast, p-ast. Let students hear that only the first sound changes.



fast



mast

- 2 Add a new sound to the front of **-ast**. What do you get with **p**? What about **bl**?

Nim on the Moon



Nim is a robot.

Nim has a small red rocket.

Blast off! The rocket goes up **fast**.

Zoom! Zoom! Past the stars.

- 1 Read the four sentences with your teacher. Then count them.
How many full stops can you find?

Nim is a name, so it gets a big letter every time.



rocket



fast



star

Up the moon hill



Nim lands on the moon.

The moon is big. It has lots of hills.

Nim runs up a hill with a golf **club**.

Nim hits a moon rock. It is a big hit!



hill



club



rock

→ Go a bit further

What would you take to the moon? Say one thing, and say why.

The Moon Shop



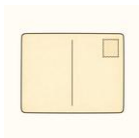
Oh no. Nim has lost the club.

Nim goes to the Moon Shop.

Nim gets a card and a new moon rock.

Then Nim sends the card home to Mum.

- 1 Read the story right through from the start. What happened first? What happened last?



card



moon



last

A story goes in order. Change the order and it stops making sense.

True, and in order



1 Circle **true** or **not true** for each one.

The moon has lots of hills.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

Nim runs down the hill.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

Nim lost the golf club.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

Nim sends a card to Mum.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

2 Put the four sentences in order. Write 1, 2, 3, 4.

☐

Nim hits a moon rock.

☐

Nim goes to the Moon Shop.

☐

Blast off! The rocket goes up.

☐

Nim lands on the moon.



Draw the story

- 1 Draw Nim's trip in four boxes. Box 1 is blast off. Box 4 is the Moon Shop. You decide what goes in the middle.

1	2	3	4
---	---	---	---

- 2 Now write a message on this postcard. Say where you are and what you have seen.

A postcard has a short message, not a whole story.

your message



Goodnight, Moon Boat

Goodnight, Moon Boat

Moon boat, moon boat, sailing so **high**,
Who is your captain up there in the **sky**?
Sail past my window, sail past my **bed**,
Then rest your white sail on a cloud **overhead**.

● ● ● ● Say it softly. This one is a bedtime rhyme.

A Prime Books poem



- 1 Read the poem with your teacher. Find the two words that rhyme with each other in the first two lines.
- 2 Now find the rhyming pair in the last two lines.

Sailors have used the moon to find their way for thousands of years.

The words from Stop 4



Space words and story words, each with its picture.



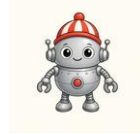
moon



star



rocket



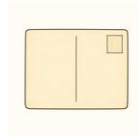
robot



hill



club



card



rock



fast



last



mast



nest



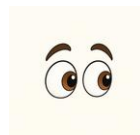
hat



bed



up



look

Find the four words that end with -ast or -est. Say them.

Build your own robot



- 1 Collect boxes, lids and bottle tops. Anything with a good shape.
- 2 Build your robot. Give it arms, and something for a face.
- 3 Give it a name. Write the name on a label.
- 4 Tell your class what your robot can do that Nim cannot.

Practise once before you show your class. Once is enough to make the second time feel easy.

Think about this stop

Colour one circle for each line. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, red means not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer.

I can read the story in the right order.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can say what a sentence starts with.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can read words in the -ast family.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can write a message on a postcard.	☐ ☐ ☐

Now I can

- ☐ I can read a story that happens in order.
- ☐ I can put four sentences in order.
- ☐ I can count the sentences on a page.
- ☐ I can read fast, last and mast.

★ SAY THESE BEFORE YOU GO



moon



rocket



fast

Next stop: 5 · Funny fish

5

STOP 5

Funny fish

Three fish, one big grin, and a very good hiding place. Words that describe are the point of this stop.



- 1 Three Bright Fish
- 2 Words that describe
- 3 Colour words and joining with and
- 4 The -ight family

Before you read

Look and guess

The story is called **Three Bright Fish**. How many fish do you think are in it? What colours might they be? Do you think they are friends?

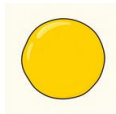
On this stop you will

- ✓ use words that describe
- ✓ say the colour of something
- ✓ join two describing words with and
- ✓ read words in the -ight family

Colour words



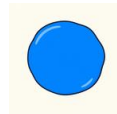
red



yellow



brown



blue



green

warm
up

Point at something red in your classroom. Now something blue. Now say the colour of your own shoes.

The sound igh



Three letters, and only **one** sound: it says **igh**, the same as the name of the letter **i**. English does this sometimes, and now you know.

igh

look

igh

now trace

🎵 -ight



bright



light



night

Now make igh yourself

- 1 Say every word out loud. Which have the sound at the **start**, and which at the **end**? Then copy the two words below.

-ight is a high-value rime because it appears in so many common words, but it cannot be decoded letter by letter. Teach it as one chunk and say so openly: this is a chunk you learn, not one you work out.

Build new words by swapping the onset: br-ight, l-ight, n-ight, r-ight, s-ight, t-ight, m-ight, f-ight.



light



night

- 2 Put these sounds in front of **-ight** and say what you get: **r**, **t**, **m**, **fl**.

Three Bright Fish



Three fish swim in the sea.

“I am **red** and I am **bright**,” said the first fish.

“I am **yellow**, bright as the sun,” said the next.

“I am **brown** and I am spotty,” said the last one.

Words that describe

Some words tell you what a thing is **like**: red, yellow, brown, bright, spotty. They are called **describing words**, and they make a picture in your head.

1 Read the story again. Which fish is spotty?

Look at ME!



“Look at ME!” said the red fish. “I am the best fish here.”
Swish, swish, swish.
A big fish came along, with a very wide grin.
The red fish was not there any more.

1 Read it out loud. Use a very proud voice for the red fish.

→ Go a bit further

Why do you think the red fish did not see the big fish coming? Talk about it with your partner.

The clever one



The yellow fish went very still.

“I can hide,” it said. “I can look like a **stone**.”

The big fish swam right past.

“He can not see me!” said the yellow fish.



stone



seaweed



shell

Being loud is not the same as being clever.

Which fish is which?



- 1 Sort the describing words. Which belong to the red fish, and which belong to the brown fish?

red

spotty

bright

brown

loud

quiet

The red fish is

.....
.....
.....

The brown fish is

.....
.....
.....

- 2 Join two describing words with **and**. Read the example, then write your own.

The fish is **red** and **bright**.

your sentence

.....
.....

★ **Big challenge**

Describe yourself with two words joined by **and**.

Two rhymes to say out loud

A Fish With Five Fine Fins

A fish with five fine **fins**
Fell in a dish of **tins**.
It said, “This is not the sea!”
And swam back home for **tea**.

● ● ● ● Four beats a line. Clap it twice.

One, Two, Shells on the Shore

One, two, shells on the **shore**,
Three, four, I found **more**.
Five, six, one is **bright**,
I will keep that one **tonight**.

● ● ● ● Count on your fingers as you say the numbers.

Two Prime Books rhymes

- 1 Read both poems out loud. Which one did you like better? Tell your partner why.

★ WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Make up a nonsense rhyme



A rock pool. Five things live in it. Can you name them?

- 1 Finish this rhyme. It does not have to make sense. It only has to rhyme, and it should be funny.

A funny old fish in a hat and a coat
Went for a sail in a ...

your ending

boat

coat

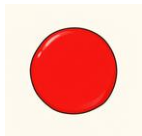
goat

float

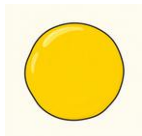
- 2 Say your rhyme to your class. Then choose your favourite one that somebody else made up.

The words from Stop 5

Describing words, colour words and sea words, each with its picture.



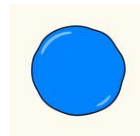
red



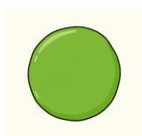
yellow



brown



blue



green



bright



light



night



fish



fin



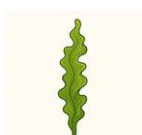
shell



starfish



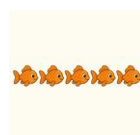
crab



seaweed



stone



five

Choose two describing words. Join them with and.

Make a fish that hides



- 1 Cut a fish shape out of paper. Make it as big as your hand.
- 2 Colour it so it matches something in your classroom.
- 3 Hide it against that thing. Can a friend find it?
- 4 Tell your class two describing words for your fish.

Practise once before you show your class. Once is enough to make the second time feel easy.

Think about this stop

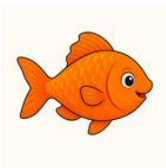
Colour one circle for each line. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, red means not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer.

I can use words that describe.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can join two words with and.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can read words in the -ight family.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can make up a rhyme.	☐ ☐ ☐

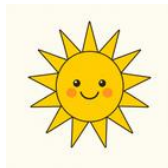
Now I can

- ☐ I can describe something with two words.
- ☐ I can name five colours.
- ☐ I can read bright, light and night.
- ☐ I can read a poem out loud.

★ SAY THESE BEFORE YOU GO



fish



bright



shell

Next stop: 6 · Good food

6

STOP 6

Good food

Everything on your plate came from somewhere. This stop is about finding out where.

1

Food from the sea

2

Food from the field

3

Food from the oven

4

Joining sentences with and

What is on your plate?

 Before we start

What did you eat yesterday? Where do you think each thing came from before it reached your plate? Which food is your favourite of all?

 On this stop you will

- ✓ say where different foods come from
- ✓ read facts and complete a sentence
- ✓ join two parts with and or or
- ✓ sort vegetables into groups



A plate with a bit of everything on it.

1 Point at each thing on the plate. Say what it is. Which part came from the sea? Which part grew in a field?

**warm
up**

Say your favourite food. Now say it again, and add a describing word in front of it.

Food from the sea



Boats come back in the morning with the night's catch.

Fish live in the sea, in rivers and in lakes.
People catch fish with nets and with rods.
In Portugal a lot of fish is caught close to the shore.
Some fish is grilled, and some is put in tins.

- 1 Read the facts. Then finish these sentences out loud, and then on the line.

Fish live in

People catch fish with

★ Did you know?

Portugal eats more fish per person than almost any other country in Europe. The sardine is the one most people think of first.

Food from the field



Fruit and vegetables. All of them are plants.

We eat different parts of a plant

A **carrot** is a root. An **onion** is a bulb. A **cabbage** is a leaf. So when you eat your vegetables you are eating roots, bulbs and leaves.

1 Sort these three vegetables into the right tray.

carrot

onion

cabbage

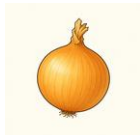
Root

Bulb

Leaf



carrot



onion



grape



pear

The sound ee



Two **e** letters side by side make one long sound: **ee**, like the noise you make when you see something exciting.

ee

look

ee

now trace



bee



tree



seed

Now make ee yourself



- 1 Say every word out loud. Which have the sound at the **start**, and which at the **end**? Then copy the two words below.

ee is the first long-vowel digraph in this book. Contrast it directly with the short e taught in Part One: e says its short sound, ee says its name.

Bee, tree and seed all end in the sound, which makes it easy to hear. Words with ee in the middle, like green and sweet, come next.



bee



tree

- 2 Say **bee**, then **tree**, then **seed**. The **ee** sound never changes.

Food from the oven



Bread starts as flour, water and a little patience.

Bread is made mostly from flour.

Flour is made from wheat, and wheat is a grass.

Farmers grow the wheat in big fields.

The baker adds water, and then heat does the rest.

- 1 Say the four things you need to make bread. Count them on your fingers.



bread



flour



water

→ Go a bit further

Look at a loaf of bread closely. Can you see the little holes? They are bubbles of air that got trapped inside while it cooked.

Joining with and or or

👁 Two little joining words

and puts two things together: bread **and** cheese. **or** asks you to choose: bread **or** cheese. One word, and a completely different meaning.

1 Read each sentence. Circle **yes** if it is true for you.

I like bread and cheese.

YES / NO

I eat fish or eggs.

YES / NO

Milk comes from a cow.

YES / NO

2 Finish these two sentences. Use **and** in the first one and **or** in the second.

one with and, one with or



Make a food book

- 1 A fact book needs a contents page. Fill in this one for a food book you would like to make.

1	Food from the sea	2
2	Food from the field	4
3		
4		

- 2 Now design the cover of your food book in this box. Draw the food and write the title.

your cover

The words from Stop 6



Food words, each with its picture.



bread



milk



cheese



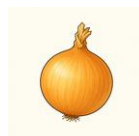
rice



bean



carrot



onion



grape



banana



tomato



pear



egg



potato



water



bee



seed

Choose two foods. Join them with and, then with or.

Make a good food poster



- 1 Choose four foods you think are good for you.
- 2 Draw each one big, in the middle of your poster.
- 3 Write the name beside each drawing.
- 4 Add one true fact at the bottom. Then show your class.

Practise once before you show your class. Once is enough to make the second time feel easy.

Think about this stop

Colour one circle for each line. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, red means not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer.

I can say where food comes from.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can finish a sentence about facts.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can use and and or.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can sort vegetables into groups.	☐ ☐ ☐

Now I can

- ☐ I can say where three foods come from.
- ☐ I can read facts and answer a question.
- ☐ I can join two parts with and or or.
- ☐ I can read words with ee.

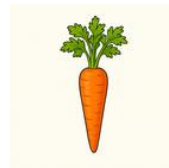
★ SAY THESE BEFORE YOU GO



bread



milk



carrot

Next stop: 7 · Story time

7

STOP 7

Story time

An old story, told again. A bun jumps off the plate and runs, and everybody wants to eat it.

1

The Little Round Bun

2

The characters, in order

3

How stories start

4

Read a recipe and put it in order

A very old story



Before we start

Some stories are so old that nobody knows who first told them. They were passed from person to person for hundreds of years. Do you know a story like that? Who told it to you?

On this stop you will

- ✓ read a traditional story
- ✓ name the characters in the right order
- ✓ join in with the part that repeats
- ✓ read words with oa

What makes a traditional story

A traditional story often has a bit that comes back **again and again**. Once you spot it, you can join in and say it too. Listen for it in this one.

- 1** Look at the picture on the page before this one. What do you think the bun is about to do?

The Little Round Bun



A man baked one little round bun.
He sat down with his wife to eat it.
But the bun hopped off the plate and ran!
“Stop!” said the man. The bun did not stop.

- 1 Read it with your teacher. Say the word **ran** quickly, the way the bun runs.



bun



oven



tray

A story needs somebody who wants something. The man wants his bun back.

Too fast for you



The bun met a sheep in the lane.

“Stand still! I will eat you,” said the sheep.

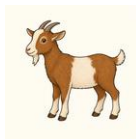
“I am **too fast** for the man and his wife,
and I am **too fast for you!**” said the bun.

Its little legs ran so fast that the bun got away.

- 1 Read it again. This time say the bun's part all together as a class. That part comes back every time.



sheep



goat



road

The cunning fox



Then the bun met a fox by the river.

“What a fine little bun,” said the fox, very politely.

“The river is wide. Get on my back and I will carry you.”

“Trust me,” said the fox.

And that, I am sorry to say, was the end of the little round bun.

- 1 Why did the bun get on the fox's back? Talk about it. Was the fox being kind, or clever?

The bun escaped from everybody who shouted, and was caught by the one who was polite.

The sound oa



o and **a** together say the name of the letter **o**. One long sound, two letters, and the **a** stays quiet.

oa

look

oa

now trace

🎵 -oat



boat



coat



goat

Now make oa yourself



- 1 Say every word out loud. Which have the sound at the **start**, and which at the **end**? Then copy the two words below.

oa follows ee from the previous stop, so the pattern generalises: a vowel pair often says the name of the first vowel. Say that rule out loud, and then say that English breaks it sometimes.

The -oat family is small and neat: boat, coat, goat, float, throat. Build them by swapping the onset.



boat



goat

- 2 Put **fl** in front of **-oat**. Now put **thr**. What two words do you get?

Who came first?



- 1 The bun met three others. Put them in the order they appear in the story. Write 1, 2, 3.

☐ The fox by the river.

☐ The man and his wife in the kitchen.

☐ The sheep in the lane.

- 2 Draw the story in four boxes. Start in the kitchen. End at the river.

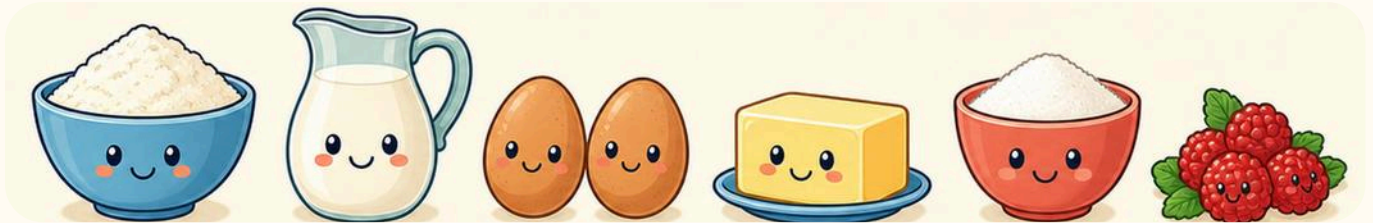
1	2	3	4
---	---	---	---

How stories start

Traditional stories nearly always start the same few ways: **Once upon a time ... Long ago and far away ... There once was ...** Any of them tells you at once that this is a story.

Berry Hill buns

- 1 Read the ingredients. Say how many there are.



Six things, and that is all you need.



flour



butter



sugar



berry

- 2 These four steps are in the wrong order. Put them right. Write 1, 2, 3, 4.

☐

Put the tray in the oven.

☐

Mix the flour, butter and sugar.

☐

Leave the buns to cool.

☐

Add the berries and stir.

Six buns, out of the oven and cooling. Count them.

Start your own story



1 Choose one of these story starters. Read it out loud.

Once upon a time ...

Long ago and far away ...

There once was a ...

2 Now write the **first sentence** of your own story. Just one sentence. Big letter, full stop.

your first sentence

★ Big challenge

Say the rest of your story out loud to a partner. You do not have to write it down. A story is a story even when it is only spoken.

★ WORDS ON THIS PAGE



STOP 7

bun



fox



road

106

The words from Stop 7

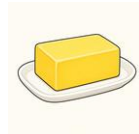
Story words and baking words, each with its picture.



bun



flour



butter



sugar



berry



oven



tray



spoon



sheep



goat



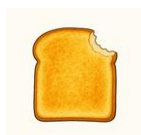
coat



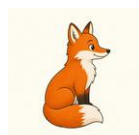
boat



road



toast



fox



river

Find the four words with oa in them. Say them out loud.

Make your own story book



- 1 Fold two sheets of paper in half and staple the fold.
- 2 Draw your story, one picture on each page.
- 3 Write one sentence under each picture.
- 4 Read your book to your class, using your storyteller voice.

Practise once before you show your class. Once is enough to make the second time feel easy.

Think about this stop

Colour one circle for each line. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, red means not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer.

I can read a traditional story.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can name the characters in order.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can read words with oa.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can put a recipe in the right order.	☐ ☐ ☐

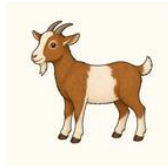
Now I can

- ☐ I can read a traditional story.
- ☐ I can join in with the part that repeats.
- ☐ I can put the steps of a recipe in order.
- ☐ I can read boat, coat and goat.

★ SAY THESE BEFORE YOU GO



bun



goat



coat

Next stop: 8 · How I feel

8

STOP 8

How I feel

A small penguin cannot find anybody. This stop is about the words for how we feel, and about telling a story from facts.



1 The Penguin Who Lost His Friends

2 Words for feelings

3 Adding -ing to a word

4 Fact file: real penguins

Words for how we feel

 Before we start

Have you ever looked for a friend and not been able to find them?
How did that feel? What made it better in the end?

 On this stop you will

- ✓ use words for how you feel
- ✓ say why a character feels that way
- ✓ add -ing to a word
- ✓ read words with oo in the middle

Feeling words



happy



sad



cross



proud



shy

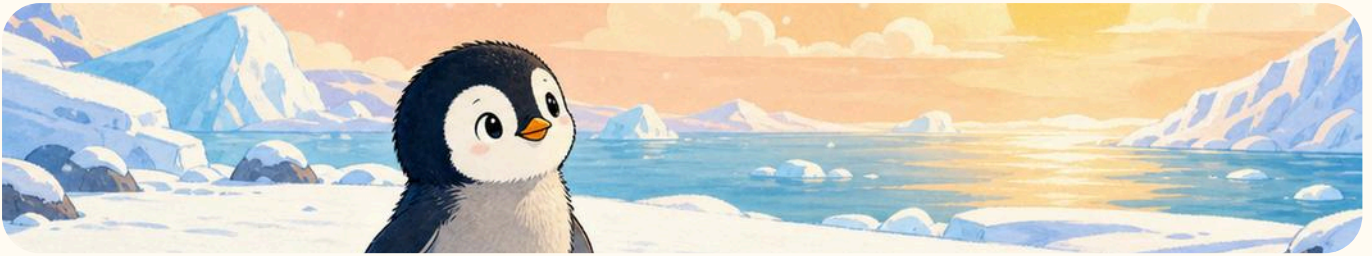


kind

warm
up

Show the feeling on your own face, without saying the word. Can your partner guess which one it is?

The Penguin Who Lost His Friends



Crunch, crunch. Who is coming through the snow?

It is Penguin. He is looking for his friends.

Penguin looks and looks. He can not find them.

Penguin feels very small on the big white hill.

- 1 Read the four sentences. How do you think Penguin feels?
Which word would you choose?

happy

sad

cross

shy



penguin



snow



ice

Down the slope



Penguin runs through the snow.

Penguin slides on the frosty ice.

He is **looking** everywhere.

Then Penguin stops at the edge and **looks** down.

Adding -ing

Put **-ing** on the end of a word and it means it is happening **right now**: look becomes **looking**, slide becomes **sliding**, swim becomes **swimming**.

- 1 Say each word, then say it again with **-ing** on the end: **look**, **run**, **slide**.

Splash!



Are his friends down there at the bottom?

Penguin jumps into the air. SPLASH!

Yes! There they all are, swimming in the cold water.

They laugh and say, “Where have you been?”

- 1 How does Penguin feel now? Has that changed since the first page?

A good story often takes a character from one feeling to a different one. That change is the story.



swimming

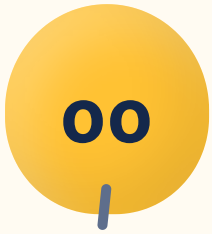


sliding



happy

The sound oo



Two **o** letters together, and this time the sound comes from deep in your mouth: **oo**, as in **look** and **book**.

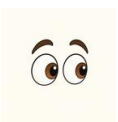
oo

look



now trace

🎵 -ook



look



book



hoop

🎵 -ool



pool



room



moon

Now make oo yourself



- 1 Say every word out loud. Which have the sound at the **start**, and which at the **end**? Then copy the two words below.

oo has two sounds in English: the short one in look and book, and the long one in pool and moon. Both are here on purpose. Say both, name the difference, and do not pretend the language is tidier than it is.

Pupils who read pool as though it rhymed with look are applying a rule correctly. Praise the reasoning, then teach the exception.



look



book

- 2 Say **book** and then **moon**. Both have **oo**. Do they sound the same?

Match the sentence

- 1 Read the four sentences. Draw a line to the picture that matches.

Penguin is sliding on the ice.

Penguin is swimming in the sea.

Penguin is looking for his friends.



sliding



swimming



looking

- 2 Add **-ing** to each word and write the new word.

look

slide

swim

swim gets an extra m: swimming. Some words do that. Listen for the short sound in the middle.

Fact file: real penguins



Penguins are birds, but they can not fly.

They use their wings as **flippers** to swim.

The biggest is the emperor penguin, about as tall as your teacher's waist.

The smallest is the little blue penguin, about as tall as a ruler.

1 Circle **true** or **not true**.

Penguins are birds.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

Penguins can fly.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

A baby penguin is called a chick.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

The emperor penguin is the biggest.

TRUE / NOT TRUE

Penguins drink sea water. A special gland above the eyes takes the salt

A story, or the facts?

Two ways to write about a penguin

The story about Penguin is **made up**. Somebody invented him. The fact file is **true**. Both are about penguins, but they do completely different jobs.

- 1 Which one would you read if you wanted to know how tall an emperor penguin is? Which would you read at bedtime?
- 2 Draw Penguin's story in four boxes, and write a caption under each one. Start with Penguin alone. End with the splash.

1	2	3	4
---	---	---	---

→ Go a bit further

Which did you prefer, the story or the fact file? There is no right answer. Say why you chose yours.

The words from Stop 8

Feeling words and penguin words, each with its picture.



penguin



chick



snow



ice



sea



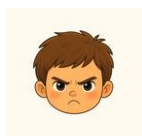
flipper



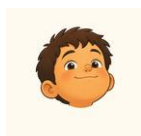
happy



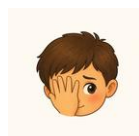
sad



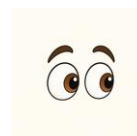
cross



proud



shy



look



book



pool



room



hoop

Choose a feeling word. Say when you last felt like that.

Make a feelings mask



- 1 Choose a feeling from this stop. Do not tell anybody which.
- 2 Draw that feeling on a paper plate. Big eyes, big mouth.
- 3 Tape it to a stick so you can hold it up.
- 4 Hold it up and see if your class can guess. Then say why somebody might feel it.

Practise once before you show your class. Once is enough to make the second time feel easy.

Think about this stop

Colour one circle for each line. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, red means not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer.

I can use words for how I feel.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can say why Penguin felt lonely.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can add -ing to a word.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can tell the story from the facts.	☐ ☐ ☐

Now I can

- ☐ I can name six feelings.
- ☐ I can say why a character feels that way.
- ☐ I can add -ing to a word.
- ☐ I can read look, book, pool and moon.

★ SAY THESE BEFORE YOU GO



penguin



snow



happy

Next stop: 9 · Kind and true

9

STOP 9

Kind and true

The last stop. A spider who will not share, a tortoise who is very patient, and a lesson that arrives at the bottom of a river.



1

Anansi and Tortoise

2

Naming words in a sentence

3

The wh sound

4

Write a new ending

What are good manners?

Before we start

Somebody arrives at your door just as you are about to eat. What is the kind thing to do? Has anybody ever shared something with you when they did not have to?

On this stop you will

- ✓ read a story with a lesson in it
- ✓ talk about how a character behaves
- ✓ find the naming words in a sentence
- ✓ read words that start with wh



Anansi the spider, and a table full of food.

- 1 Look at the picture. Anansi has a lot of food. Tortoise has just arrived. What do you think Anansi is going to say?

Anansi and Tortoise

Anansi the spider sat down to eat.

There was rice, beans and sweet potato on the table.

Knock, knock! It was Tortoise.

“What a lovely smell,” said Tortoise. “May I come in?”

“Of course,” said Anansi. But he did not want to share.

1 Read it with your teacher. Did Anansi mean what he said?



spider



tortoise



bowl

Sometimes what a person says and what a person wants are two different things.

Go and wash your hands

“Oh Tortoise, your hands are dirty,” said Anansi.

“You can not eat with dirty hands. Go and wash them.”

Tortoise walked all the way to the river and washed.

By the time he came back, every bowl was empty.

“**What** a shame,” said Anansi.

- 1 Was Anansi being fair? Talk about it with your partner. What would you have said to him?

greedy

mean

kind

generous

patient

★ WORDS ON THIS PAGE



wet



dish



mug

The sound wh



wh starts nearly every question you will ever ask: **what**, **when**, **where**, **who**, **why**. Blow a little air out as you say it.

wh

look

wh

now trace

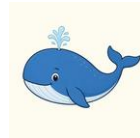
🎵 wh



why



wheel



whale

Now make wh yourself



- 1 Say every word out loud. Which have the sound at the **start**, and which at the **end**? Then copy the two words below.

wh is grouped here as a question-word family, not just a sound. Knowing that wh usually signals a question is more useful to a reader than the phoneme.

Note that who breaks the pattern in pronunciation. Point at it, name it as an oddity, and move on.



why



whale

- 2 Ask your partner a question that starts with **what**. Now one that starts with **where**.

Tortoise waits



The next day, Tortoise asked Anansi to dinner.

Tortoise lived at the bottom of the river.

Anansi put stones in his pockets so he would sink.

Down, down, down he went, right to the table.

- 1 Why did Anansi put stones in his pockets? Say what you think will happen next.



river



stone



pocket

A coat full of stones



“Take off your coat at the table,” said Tortoise. “Those are the manners here.”

Anansi took off his coat. Up he floated, straight to the top! He bobbed on the water while Tortoise ate every bowl.

“This time,” said Anansi, “Tortoise has tricked me.”

- 1 Read the end of the story. Did Anansi learn anything? What do you think he will do next time somebody knocks?

The way you treat other people usually comes back round to you.

Naming words and mixed-up sentences

- 1 Read the sentence. Find the three **naming words** and circle them.

Anansi put stones in his pockets and sank to the table.

- 2 These sentences are mixed up. Say them in the right order, then write one out properly.

the

Anansi

floated

to

top

write it properly

- 3 Check your sentence. Big letter at the start? Full stop at the end?



table



door



pot

Two Mice and a Marvellous Meal

Two Mice and a Marvellous Meal

Two little mice in a hollow old **log**
Made a marvellous meal in the middle of the **fog**.
They stirred in the moonlight, they stirred till it **shone**,
Then said, “Come and share it!” and everyone **gone**.

● ● ● ● Say it in a tiny mouse voice, then a big one.

A Prime Books poem



- 1 Read the poem out loud with a partner. How many characters are in it? Find two rhyming words. Find two naming words.
- 2 The mice did the opposite of what Anansi did. Say what they did differently.

Write a new ending

- 1 Imagine Anansi **did** share his dinner on the very first day. How would the story end then? Tell your partner first.

your new ending

★ Big challenge

Act out your new ending with a partner. One of you is Anansi and one is Tortoise. Use your face and your hands, not just your words.

For teachers

Rewriting an ending assesses comprehension more honestly than answering questions does: a pupil cannot change an outcome they have not understood. Accept oral endings from pupils who are still building transcription fluency. Record a few on paper for them so their ideas are not limited by their pencil.

The words from Stop 9

Story words and question words, each with its picture.



spider



tortoise



table



bowl



door



river



pocket



mouse



pot



kind



why



wheel



whale



cry



dry



fly

Find the four words that start with wh. Ask a question with one.

Act out the whole story



1 Choose your parts. You need Anansi, Tortoise, and somebody to narrate.

2 Find two props: a bowl, and something for a shell.

3 Practise twice. Make Anansi sound polite but not honest.

4 Perform it. Then ask your class what they think Anansi learned.

Practise once before you show your class. Once is enough to make the second time feel easy.

Think about this stop

Colour one circle for each line. Green means yes, yellow means nearly, red means not yet. Not yet is a perfectly good answer.

I can read a story with a lesson.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can say how a character behaved.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can find naming words in a sentence.	☐ ☐ ☐
I can write a new ending.	☐ ☐ ☐

Now I can

- ☐ I can talk about how a character behaves.
- ☐ I can find the naming words in a sentence.
- ☐ I can read words that start with wh.
- ☐ I can put a mixed-up sentence in order.

★ SAY THESE BEFORE YOU GO



spider



tortoise



kind

That is the end of the trail. Turn over.

Our reading party



The end of the trail. Everybody shows one thing they made.

You have walked all nine stops. Now show somebody what you can do.

- 1 Look back through this book. Find the page you are proudest of.
- 2 Choose one story to read out loud. Practise it twice.
- 3 Choose one thing you made: a sign, a robot, a fish, a mask or a book.
- 4 Stand up and show your class. Say why you chose that page.

For teachers

Run this as a real event rather than a lesson. Invite another class in if you can: an audience beyond the teacher changes how carefully pupils prepare.

Every pupil should leave having read something aloud successfully, so let students choose their own passage. Choice is what makes the success real.

My best work this year

- 1 Draw or write the thing you are proudest of in the frame below. Then write one sentence saying why.

my best work

why I chose it

Look how much I can do

- ☐ I can say all five vowels and write them.
- ☐ I can read my ten by-heart words.
- ☐ I can hear the first sound and the last sound in a word.
- ☐ I can read a whole story with my teacher.
- ☐ I can read some stories on my own.
- ☐ I can write a sentence with a big letter and a full stop.

Signed by me:

Reading through the year



The same tree, four times, across one school year.



Spring

Plant a seed in a pot. Write one word each week about what it did.



Summer

Read outside. Take one book and one friend and sit under a tree.



Autumn

Collect five leaves. Label each one with a describing word.



Winter

Make a card for somebody. Write their name with a big letter.

★ Did you know?

Children who are read to for fifteen minutes a day hear millions more words in a year than children who are not. Fifteen minutes is not very long, and it adds up to a great deal.

Keep a reading tree on the wall. Add a paper leaf for every book.

Every word you met



Hoot keeps the word book. Now it is yours.

This is your own dictionary. Every word from every stop is here, and **every single one has its own picture**, so you can always find the word you want even before you can read it.

- 1 Choose any page. Point at a word and say it. Then read what it means underneath.

★ Did you know?

A dictionary puts words in alphabet order so that anybody can find any word without reading the whole book. This word book is in **trail order** instead, so you can see how far you came.

For teachers

Every entry was harvested automatically from the units' own word pages, so a word cannot appear here without having been taught, and cannot be taught without appearing here.

Use it for retrieval practice: name a stop, find three words in ten seconds.

Stop 1 • Going places (1 of 3)



bus

a big bus that lots of people ride
on



bike

you push the pedals round to
make it go



car

it has four wheels and a door
each side



van

a big box on wheels for carrying
things



train

it runs on rails and pulls
carriages



boat

it floats, and the wind pushes its
sail

Stop 1 • Going places (2 of 3)



stop

the place where the bus waits
for you



hill

ground that goes up, then down
again



bell

you press it or ring it to make a
sound



pond

a small patch of water with
ducks on it



clock

it tells you what the time is



town

lots of houses and shops close
together

Stop 1 • Going places (3 of 3)



shop

you go in to buy something



sign

it has words on it to tell you something



grandpa

your mother's or your father's father



run

to go as fast as your legs will take you

Read all 16 words from Stop 1 out loud. Then choose your favourite and say why you like it.

Stop 2 · Having fun (1 of 3)



run

to go as fast as your legs will
take you



hop

to jump along on one leg



jog

to run gently, and keep going



sit

to rest on your bottom



box

a container with straight sides



mug

a cup with a handle

Stop 2 • Having fun (2 of 3)



jug

you pour from it



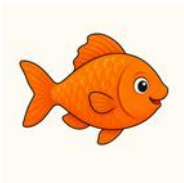
rug

a small soft carpet



frog

it hops, it swims, and it says
croak



fish

it lives in water and breathes
through gills



dish

a shallow bowl you put food in



brush

it has bristles for brushing

Stop 2 · Having fun (3 of 3)



ball

round, and it bounces



rope

a long thick string



cap

a soft hat with a peak at the front



six

the number after five

Read all 16 words from Stop 2 out loud. Then choose your favourite and say why you like it.

Stop 3 • Let us find out (1 of 3)



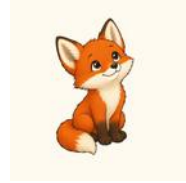
fox

a wild animal with red fur and a bushy tail



den

the hole where a fox lives



cub

a baby fox



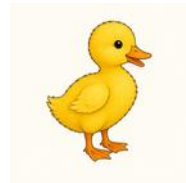
lamb

a baby sheep



calf

a baby cow



duckling

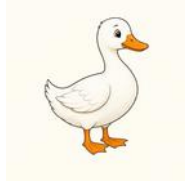
a baby duck

Stop 3 • Let us find out (2 of 3)



kitten

a baby cat



duck

a bird that swims and says
quack



ring

a circle of gold you wear on a
finger



king

a man who rules a country



sing

to make music with your voice



sock

you wear it on your foot

Stop 3 • Let us find out (3 of 3)



rock

a very hard piece of the ground



leaf

the flat green part of a plant



tree

a tall plant with a wooden trunk



fur

the soft hair that covers an animal

Read all 16 words from Stop 3 out loud. Then choose your favourite and say why you like it.

Stop 4 • Up in space (1 of 3)



moon

it goes round the Earth and
shines at night



star

a huge burning sun, very far
away



rocket

it burns fuel to push itself into
space



robot

a machine that can do a job on
its own



hill

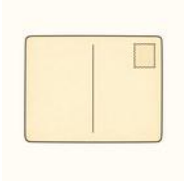
a low round rise on the moon



club

a long stick for hitting a golf ball

Stop 4 • Up in space (2 of 3)



card

you write a message on it and
post it



rock

a very hard piece of the ground



fast

moving quickly



last

at the very end



mast

the tall pole that holds up a sail



nest

a bird builds it to hold its eggs

Stop 4 • Up in space (3 of 3)



hat

you wear it on your head



bed

where you sleep



up

the way away from the ground

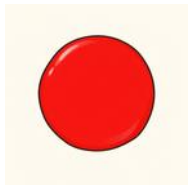


look

to point your eyes at something

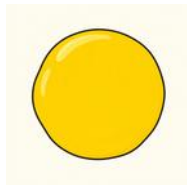
Read all 16 words from Stop 4 out loud. Then choose your favourite and say why you like it.

Stop 5 • Funny fish (1 of 3)



red

the colour of a tomato



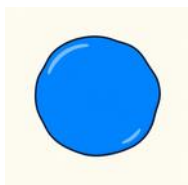
yellow

the colour of the sun



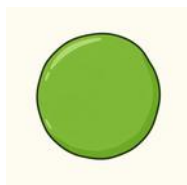
brown

the colour of soil



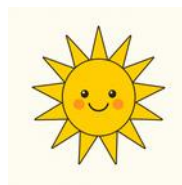
blue

the colour of the sky



green

the colour of grass



bright

shining, easy to see

Stop 5 • Funny fish (2 of 3)



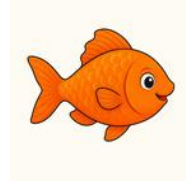
light

what lets you see; not dark



night

the dark part of the day



fish

it lives in water and breathes through gills



fin

a fish uses it to steer and swim



shell

the hard case an animal lives in



starfish

a sea animal with five arms

Stop 5 • Funny fish (3 of 3)



crab

it walks sideways and has two claws



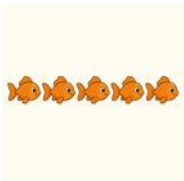
seaweed

a plant that grows in the sea



stone

a small hard piece of rock



five

the number after four

Read all 16 words from Stop 5 out loud. Then choose your favourite and say why you like it.

Stop 6 • Good food (1 of 3)



bread

made from flour, water and heat



milk

a white drink that comes from a cow



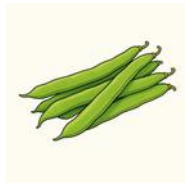
cheese

made from milk, and it is firm



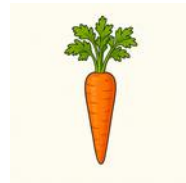
rice

small white grains you boil



bean

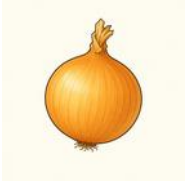
a green vegetable in a long pod



carrot

an orange root you can eat

Stop 6 • Good food (2 of 3)



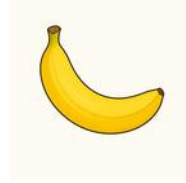
onion

a bulb with papery skin



grape

small round fruit that grow in bunches



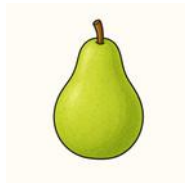
banana

a long yellow fruit you peel



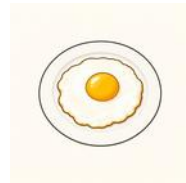
tomato

a round red fruit for salad



pear

a green fruit, narrow at the top



egg

a hen lays it, and you can cook it

Stop 6 • Good food (3 of 3)



potato

it grows under the ground



water

the drink that has no colour at all



bee

it makes honey and buzzes

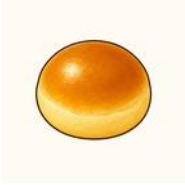


seed

a tiny thing that grows into a plant

Read all 16 words from Stop 6 out loud. Then choose your favourite and say why you like it.

Stop 7 • Story time (1 of 3)



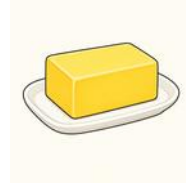
bun

a small round sweet bread



flour

white powder made from wheat



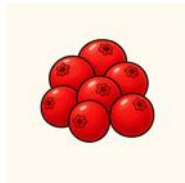
butter

made from cream, and it is yellow



sugar

white grains that make food sweet



berry

a small soft fruit



oven

the hot box that bakes your food

Stop 7 • Story time (2 of 3)



tray

a flat thing to carry food on



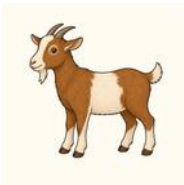
spoon

you stir and eat with it



sheep

a woolly animal that says baa



goat

it has horns and climbs
anywhere



coat

you wear it when it is cold



boat

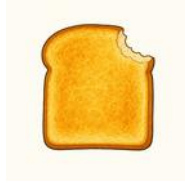
it floats and carries you on
water

Stop 7 • Story time (3 of 3)



road

the hard path that cars drive
along



toast

bread that has been made hot
and crisp



fox

a wild animal with red fur and a
bushy tail



river

water that runs down to the sea

Read all 16 words from Stop 7 out loud. Then choose your favourite and say why you like it.

Stop 8 • How I feel (1 of 3)



penguin

a bird that swims but cannot fly



chick

a baby penguin, or a baby hen



snow

soft white water, frozen and falling



ice

water that has gone hard with cold



sea

the huge salty water round the land



flipper

a penguin's wing, used for swimming

Stop 8 • How I feel (2 of 3)



happy

how you feel when things are
good



sad

how you feel when something is
wrong



cross

how you feel when something is
unfair



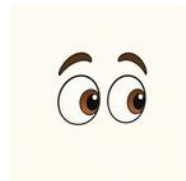
proud

how you feel when you did it
yourself



shy

how you feel when everybody
looks at you



look

to point your eyes at something

Stop 8 • How I feel (3 of 3)



book

pages joined together, full of words



pool

water you can swim in



room

a space inside a building



hoop

a big ring you can spin

Read all 16 words from Stop 8 out loud. Then choose your favourite and say why you like it.

Stop 9 • Kind and true (1 of 3)



spider

it has eight legs and spins a web



tortoise

it walks slowly and carries its shell



table

you put your plate on it



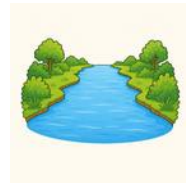
bowl

a round deep dish



door

you open it to go in



river

water that runs down to the sea

Stop 9 · Kind and true (2 of 3)



pocket

a small bag sewn into your clothes



mouse

a small animal with a long thin tail



pot

you cook in it



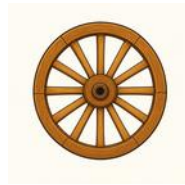
kind

thinking about somebody else first



why

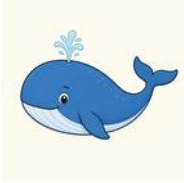
the question you ask to find a reason



wheel

it is round and it turns

Stop 9 • Kind and true (3 of 3)



whale

the biggest animal in the sea



cry

what your eyes do when you are sad



dry

not wet at all



Fly

to move through the air

Read all 16 words from Stop 9 out loud. Then choose your favourite and say why you like it.

Sources and references

Every fact in this book was checked before it was printed. These are the places we checked it. They are listed here so that a teacher, or a curious child, can go and look for themselves.

Foxes (Stop 3)

- Natural History Museum, London. *The secret life of urban foxes*. On foxes digging dens for raising cubs, and on foxes living in British towns.
- Woodland Trust. *What do foxes eat? And more fox facts*. On the red fox as an omnivore: rabbits, rodents, birds, frogs, earthworms, berries and fruit.

Penguins (Stop 8)

- On the emperor penguin as the largest living species, about 1.1 to 1.2 metres, and the little blue penguin (*Eudyptula minor*) as the smallest, at roughly 25 to 33 centimetres.
- On the supraorbital gland, the salt gland sitting above the eye, which removes sodium chloride from the bloodstream after a penguin swallows sea water.

Reading and language

- SIL International. *Andika*, the literacy typeface used for the body text of this book: single-storey a, tailed l, unambiguous I, l and 1.

Traditional stories

- **The Little Round Bun** is our own retelling of the runaway-food folk tale, a story motif found across Europe in many versions. The wording here is entirely new.
- **Anansi and Tortoise** is our own retelling of a West African trickster tale about Anansi the spider. The wording here is entirely new.

All illustrations in this book were made for Prime School.

How this book is built



How to use this book with your class

Part One comes first for a reason. The sequence used in many Year 1 courses begins reading connected text before a five-year-old has secure letter knowledge. Part One inserts twenty-three pages of foundation work ahead of that: the five vowels individually, first consonants, and the ten highest-frequency words, each with formation practice.

Every new sound gets its own page before it is needed. Each of the nine stops opens its phonics work with a **Meet the letter** page: balloon letter, formation arrows, a sound tree of picture words, then handwriting. Pupils meet the letter, make the letter, and only then read it in a story.

No answers are printed anywhere. Pupils say what they think out loud, then circle, tick, colour or write. This is deliberate: a printed answer turns a thinking task into a copying task.

Every word prints with its own picture. No picture is reused for a different word, because a nearly-right picture teaches the wrong thing.

Children copy words, not sentences, through Part One and into the early stops. One tramline per word, with the picture beside it.

The nine stops



What each stop teaches, at a glance.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | Going places
transport words · b and m · sequencing · capital for a name |
| 2 | Having fun
speech in stories · sh · doing and naming words · rhyme families |
| 3 | Let us find out
fiction and non-fiction · ng and ck · contents pages · animal young |
| 4 | Up in space
story order · the -ast rime · sentence boundaries · postcards |
| 5 | Funny fish
describing words · the -ight rime · joining with and · poems |
| 6 | Good food
non-fiction · ee · and or or · word groups · contents pages |
| 7 | Story time
traditional tales · oa · refrains · instructions in order |
| 8 | How I feel
feelings · oo · adding -ing · story against fact file |
| 9 | Kind and true
a story with a lesson · wh · naming words · a new ending |

Nine stops. One trail. A whole year of reading.



Ride the bus to Berry Hill. Meet a bun that runs away. Find out what a baby fox is called, and why a penguin cannot fly. Along the way you will learn five vowels, ten words by heart and how to write your very first sentence.

Every new word comes with its own picture, so you can read the page before you can read the words. **No answers are printed in this book:** you say what you think, then choose.

Letters

Sounds

Stories

Rhymes

Writing



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